This is a fantastic way to cook beets. The distinctive flavor of the goat cheese complements the round sweetness of the beets.

beet soup with tomatoes and goat cheese

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 45 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 2

1lb 2oz–1lb 5oz (500–600g) beets
1lb 2oz (500g) ripe tomatoes, halved
9oz (250g) apples, diced
2 tbsp olive or sunflower oil
1 medium onion, peeled and finely chopped
2 cups strong beef stock
salt and freshly ground black pepper
4½oz (125g) goat cheese

1 Preheat the oven to 375°F (190°C). Wearing gloves to keep from staining your hands, peel, and coarsely grate the beets and set aside, then place the tomatoes and apples in an ovenproof dish and drizzle with half the oil. Roast for 25–30 minutes, or until soft and pulpy, then press them through a sieve to remove the skin and seeds.

2 Heat the remaining oil in a pan and cook the onion for 6–8 minutes until soft. Add the beets and stock and bring to a boil, then season with salt and pepper and simmer gently for 10 minutes, or until the beets are tender. Stir in the tomato and apple mixture, transfer to a blender, and process until completely smooth. Taste and adjust the seasoning.

3 To serve cold, chill the soup in the refrigerator then divide between six bowls. To serve hot, reheat until piping hot but not boiling. In either case, crumble the cheese over each bowl and serve with crusty bread.